

Week 9: Sustainable Development

JSS3 Intermediate Science — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

This week introduces sustainable development — an approach to growth and development that balances present needs with the wellbeing of future generations.

Meaning and Principles

Sustainable development is development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs. Key principles include:

- **Balance** – weighing economic growth, social wellbeing, and environmental protection together
- **Long-term thinking** – considering the future impact of today's decisions
- **Equity** – ensuring fair access to resources for all people, now and in the future
- **Responsible resource use** – using natural resources efficiently and sustainably

Environmental Protection and Sustainable Use

Sustainable development requires protecting ecosystems, conserving natural resources (as studied in Week 3), and preventing environmental hazards and pollution (as studied in Weeks 4, 7, and 8), so that economic and social development does not come at the cost of a damaged environment.

SDGs Related to the Environment

The United Nations' **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** include several goals directly related to the environment:

SDG	Focus
SDG 6	Clean Water and Sanitation
SDG 7	Affordable and Clean Energy
SDG 13	Climate Action
SDG 14	Life Below Water
SDG 15	Life on Land

School Eco-Project

As a class or group project, plan a small eco-friendly initiative for your school — such as a tree-planting exercise, a waste-sorting and recycling drive, or a water conservation awareness campaign. Present your project plan, including its goals and expected environmental benefit.

Real-Life Application

Nigeria's efforts to expand access to solar power in rural areas reflect SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy), showing how sustainable development principles are applied at a national level to balance development needs with environmental responsibility.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Sustainable development	Development that meets present needs without harming future generations' ability to meet theirs
Equity	Fairness in the distribution of resources and opportunities
SDGs	Sustainable Development Goals — a set of global goals adopted by the United Nations

Evaluation Questions

- 1 Define sustainable development.
- 2 List three principles of sustainable development.
- 3 What does “SDG” stand for?
- 4 Name two SDGs directly related to the environment.
- 5 Explain what SDG 13 (Climate Action) focuses on.
- 6 Why is “long-term thinking” important for sustainable development?
- 7 Explain the principle of equity in the context of sustainable development.
- 8 Give a real-life example of a sustainable development effort in Nigeria.
- 9 Describe an idea for a school eco-project and its expected benefit.
- 10 In your own words, explain why balancing development and environmental protection matters for future generations.